

TRUST Requirements Framework

A five-gate method for converting mixed Copilot, Teams and document evidence into controlled requirements.

CORE PRINCIPLE

Copilot output is an interpretation. Trust comes from traceable evidence, authority, explicit uncertainty, human sign-off and controlled transfer.

The five gates

Gate	Question	Required evidence
T - Trace	Where did this information come from?	Source title/link, date, speaker/author and exact evidence
R - Rank	How authoritative are the source and speaker?	Source type, current version and decision rights
U - Uncertainty	What is its evidence status?	Confirmed, Proposed, Assumption, Conflict, Not confirmed, Superseded or Out of scope
S - Sign-off	Who can authorise it?	Named decision owner and explicit confirmation
T - Transfer	Can it enter the controlled register?	All gates passed; exact row/field change; human verification

Source treatment

Source	Default treatment
Current approved policy	Authoritative constraint within its scope
Approved decision log	Confirmed decision
Explicit owner confirmation	Confirmed only inside that person's decision authority
Meeting transcript	Evidence that a statement was made; not approval by itself
Meeting or post-meeting chat	Statement, correction or confirmation depending on author and wording
Stakeholder notes	Candidate evidence requiring verification
Copilot recap	Navigation aid only; verify against original evidence
Copilot answer	Never the original business source

Evidence-to-register decision matrix

Transcript?	Authority level?	Conflict?	Approval?	Treatment
Yes	Yes	No	Explicit	Transfer after human verification
Yes	Yes	Yes	Any	Hold; escalate conflict
Yes	No	No	No	Candidate or supporting context
Yes	Unclear	Any	No	Not confirmed; identify owner
No	Any	Any	Any	Reject or locate original evidence

CHANNEL IS NOT AUTHORITY

A sponsor's explicit post-meeting confirmation may be stronger than an earlier transcript. A Copilot recap remains weaker than both because it is derived content.

Minimum evidence fields

- Evidence ID and source type;
- source title or link;
- version or timestamp;
- speaker or author;
- exact supporting statement;
- authority level;
- evidence status;
- conflicting evidence;
- decision owner;
- approval status;
- eligible for transfer: Yes or No.

Final verification prompt

Apply TRUST

Apply the TRUST framework to every candidate. Return one row per item with source, author, date, authority, evidence status, conflict, decision owner, approval and transfer eligibility. Treat Copilot summaries only as navigation aids. If the original evidence cannot be cited, mark the item Not confirmed.